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# Cedar Rapids Police: Automated license plate reader use strictly regulated in the agency

A Flock brand automated license plate reader (ALPR) (WMTV)

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their potential to cause harm.

The department says its policies are strict and limit who is able to access data.

The data is only available for 30 days, and a [transparency portal](#) keeps track of how many license plate images are captured, plates associated with persons of interest and how many searches are made.

In addition, the department publicly discloses the locations of its 76 readers and releases [quarterly reports](#) on the city's website.

CRPD uses readers made by Flock Safety and Vigilant Solutions. It says outside agencies must be approved by the department before they can access the city's data.

The data is also not used for immigration enforcement, according to the department's policies.

The Department says the cameras have helped officers in a few recent cases.

Officers [arrested a man](#) this month for attempted murder connected to a drive-by shooting in January by searching traffic data from the readers.

CRPD say they also used ALPRs to find an 84-year-old man with dementia who had travelled from Cedar Rapids to Chicago and reunite him with his family.

The American Civil Liberties Union with the University of Iowa Technology Law Clinic [published a report](#) this week pointing out cases where the technology has been misused and recommending more regulations and uniform transparency.

[CRPD's policy](#) states misuse or abuse of ALPR data will result in disciplinary action and may lead to termination.

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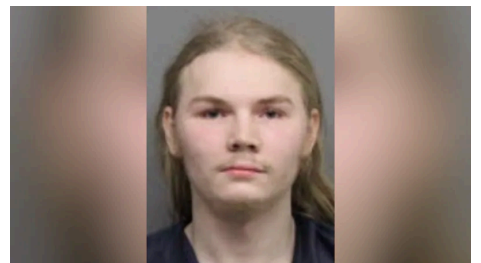


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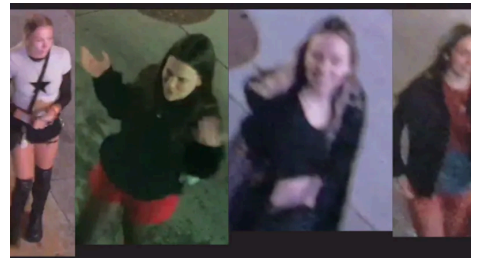
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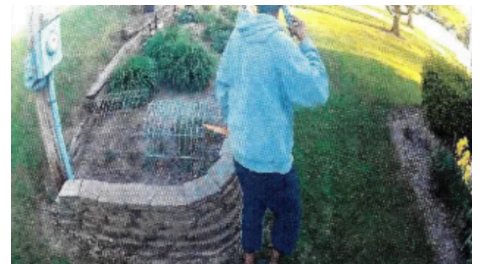
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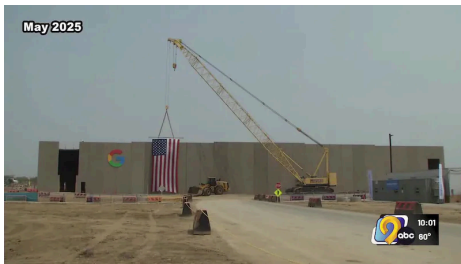
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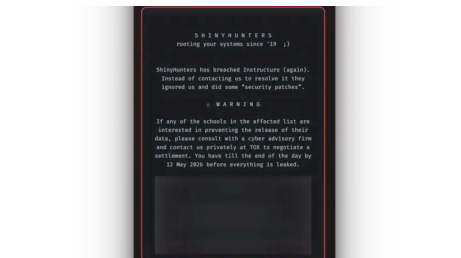
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